

NUImpact Announces Backing of LymeAlert, a Massachusetts-Based Lyme Disease Detection Startup.

Boston, Massachusetts, April 2026 - NUImpact, Northeastern University's premier impact venture capital fund, has backed LymeAlert, a healthtech startup developing rapid at-home tick testing technology, as part of its \$2.5M financing led by Bay Area Lyme Ventures.

Founded in 2016, NUImpact is a student-led venture capital fund based in Boston, Massachusetts. NUImpact aims to deploy mission-centric capital to for-profit, pre-seed – seed startups with an impact-aligned business model. With assets under management (AUM) of \$600K and an average check size of \$30K, NUImpact has made ten investments across five verticals: Education and Media, Energy and Environment, Food and Agriculture, Healthcare, and Technology and Financial Services.

LymeAlert was founded by Erin Dawicki, who identified a gap in vector-borne disease detection technology while studying at the MIT Sloan School of Management. Lyme Disease, transmitted via ticks, has been increasing rapidly in the United States, with a 25x increase in annual cases since 1982. Lyme Disease can cause chronic illness when left undetected and untreated. Current detection methods require in-office testing, which are slow and expensive at an average cost of \$3K per test.

LymeAlert seeks to improve early awareness and action around Lyme exposure with an at-home *Borrelia Burgdorferi* testing kit. The kit retails for \$50 and can test up to five ticks. Results are generated in less than 30 minutes, offering a more accessible and faster method of pathogen detection, while addressing a critical gap in the current response to tick exposure. Long term, LymeAlert is positioned to develop a data-driven platform focused on Lyme Disease surveillance, mapping, and disease intelligence.

As of April 2026, NUImpact has backed LymeAlert, with a \$30K investment via a SAFE. NUImpact is participating in LymeAlert's \$2.5M financing round, led by Bay Area Lyme Ventures. This investment marks NUImpact's third investment within the healthcare vertical and illustrates strong alignment with NUImpact's mission of strategic capital deployment to mission driven companies. The LymeAlert backing has provided NUImpact the opportunity to support an under-addressed public health solution, advancing accessibility, prevention, consumer health empowerment, and long-term health intelligence infrastructure development.

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